

Amara Okonkwo

Senior Backend Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer with 8 years building and scaling distributed Python services. Deep experience designing REST APIs, relational data models and cloud infrastructure on AWS. Led the migration of a monolithic Django application to a service-oriented architecture serving 12 million monthly requests.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Go, Bash

Frameworks: Django, Django REST Framework, Celery, FastAPI

Data: PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Kafka

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, ECS), Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions

Practices: REST APIs, microservices, TDD, CI/CD, observability

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer - Northwind Payments, London (2021 - Present)

Owned the core payments REST API built with Django REST Framework and PostgreSQL, handling roughly 400 requests per second at peak with 99.97% uptime.

Designed the sharding strategy for a 4TB PostgreSQL cluster, cutting p95 query latency by 61%.

Built the AWS infrastructure in Terraform across three regions and mentored four engineers.

Backend Engineer - Halcyon Retail Group, Manchester (2018 - 2021)

Built inventory and fulfilment REST APIs in Django serving 300+ retail locations.

Introduced Celery task pipelines that cut overnight batch processing from 6 hours to 40 minutes.

Junior Software Engineer - Bright Lane Digital, Leeds (2016 - 2018)

Developed internal Python tooling and reporting services backed by PostgreSQL.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, University of Manchester (2016) - First Class Honours

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2022)